

Company colors

When overlaying any text onto a colored background, ensure that you check the contrast rates to ensure its visibility is good enough for those with visual impairments.

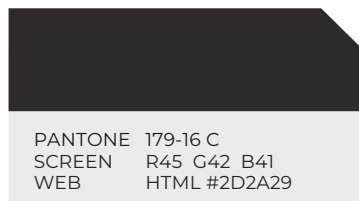
E.G. White is not a good contrast for light blue (A3C0CE). So don't use light blue against a white background (or use white on top of a light blue background) for text or icons. It's ok as a background color or for less important design elements. This is especially crucial for important or heavy amounts of text. Please ensure a **minimum** ratio of 3:1

<https://color.adobe.com/create/color-contrast-analyzer>

click here
↖

Primary colors

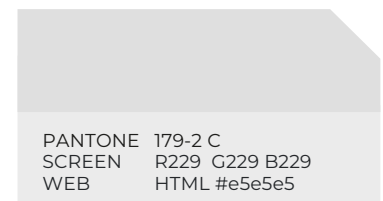
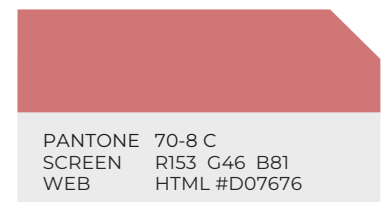
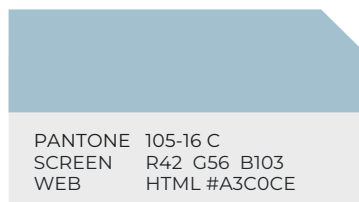
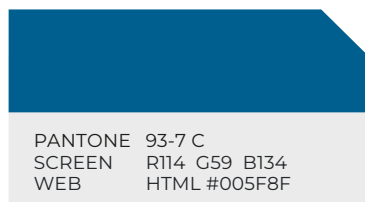
These are the main colors. Red (D62E2F) is the highlighting color and should be used whenever possible to highlight information. White (FAFAFA) is the ideal background shade. Black (2D2A29) is the ideal text color.



Secondary colors

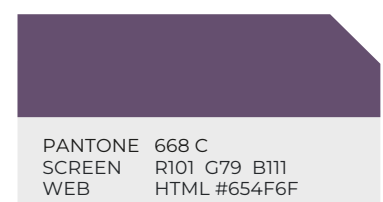
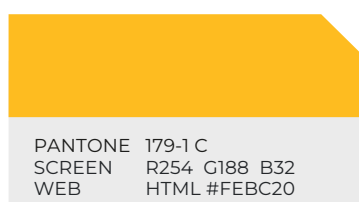
These are the additional colors we use for presentation and charts.

The use of these colours in shades is preferable to a mix of these colors and the accents



Accent colors

These are the additional colors for presentation and charts when these colors are specifically needed (E.G. Store tracker, green is needed) **Not to be used unless necessary**

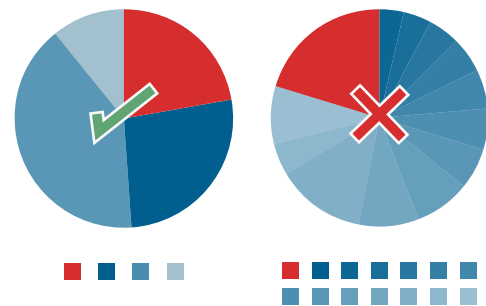


Color Application

Example 1

If there is one segment to call out, we make that segment the highlighting color (either the darkest or using red). The rest we can use the blues for. We can use the main dark blue and reduce the opacity to 70% and use the lighter blue for the third segment, giving an ombre of blue.

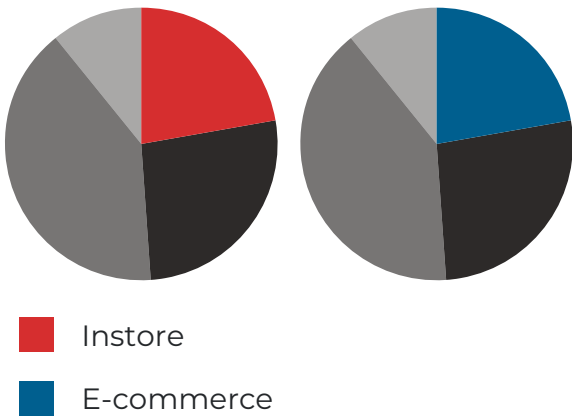
We can use this 'opacity trick' with red also, and you can use opacity at 30%, 40%, 50% etc.



But be careful the colours are still distinguishable from each other when using a legend so they're easy to identify. If not using a legend, it's fine as long as they're labelled clearly.

We can also use grey shades for this effect, especially when there are multiple 'categories' to differentiate. For example, a chart might have 'positive' 'negative' and 'neutral'. If we want to differentiate between these at a glance we could use shades of grey for negatives, blues for neutrals and reds for positives.

Shades of grey are also applicable in scenarios wherein we want to isolate a single segment and have used colors for specific categories through the report.

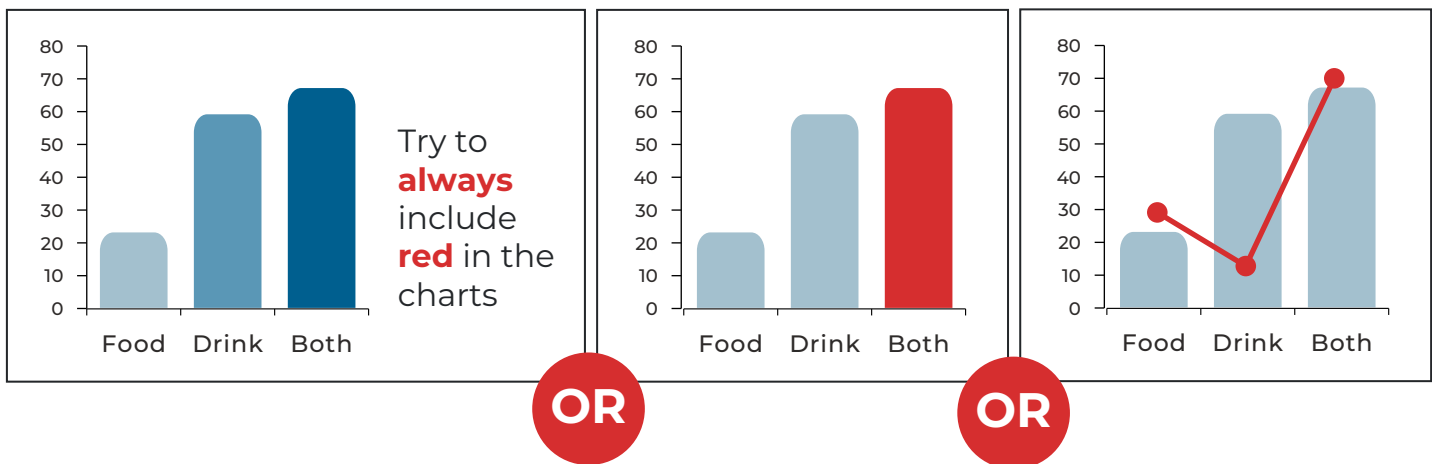


Example 2

Try to always include red in the charts, whether that's in the call-out or the chart itself. It should be used to highlight important information, and doesn't need to be the focal color.

Ideally light blue bars with red text in the callout, or light blue bars with a red line overlay.

If there is just a simple bar without call outs, you can make it solid light blue.



Color Application

Example 3

As we're trying to include red in charts, the same goes for other figures. Best practice for the 'coresight look' is to use coresight white as a background (with drop shadow or thin outline) with red bold text and red/dark grey icons. Try to use the **main colours** as much as possible.



Example 4

When comparing direct positive VS negatives, green and red can be used to easily differentiate at a glance. The use of green is only to be used as a indication of the postive when contrasted against red as a negative.


Positive

Green is often used as a positive indicator

Green is often used as a positive indicator

Green is often used as a positive indicator

Green is often used as a positive indicator


Negative

Red is often used as a negative indicator

Red is often used as a negative indicator

Red is often used as a negative indicator

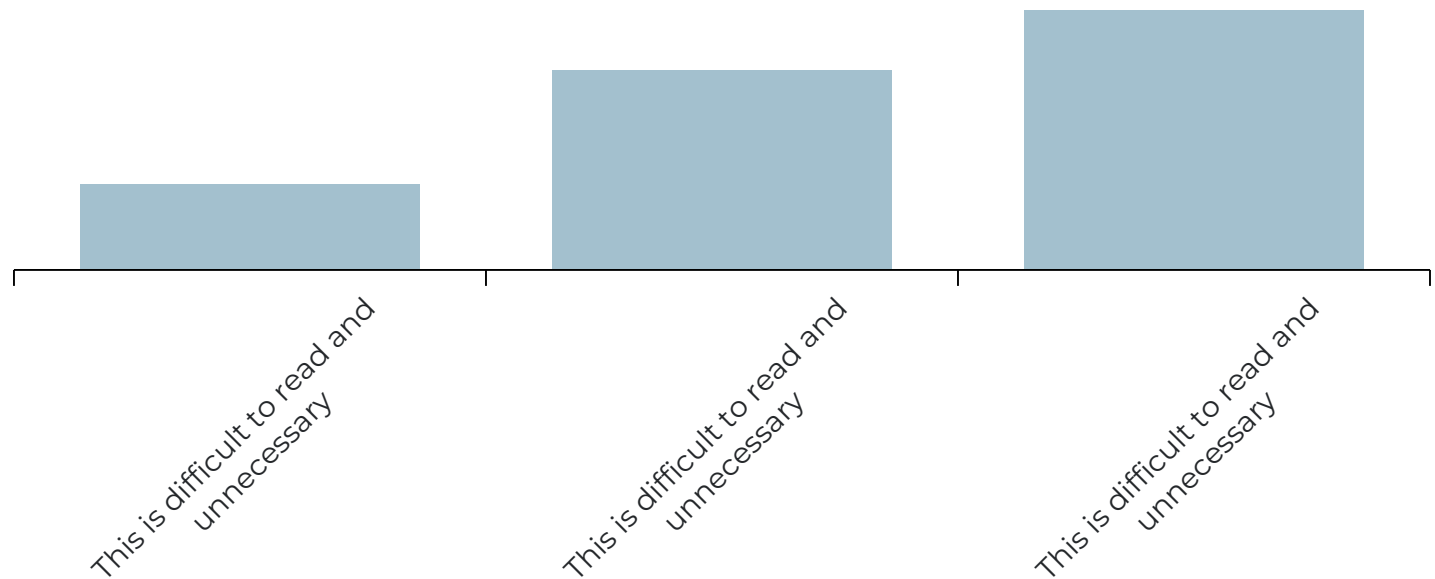
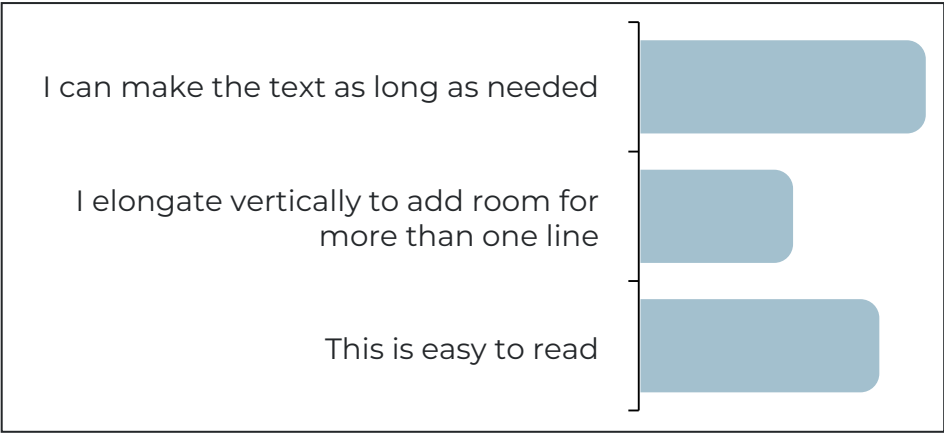
Red is often used as a negative indicator

Chart Design

Example 1

The chart should always show data in the clearest way possible. For example - charts that have long axis labels, should use a bar graph like this, so the labels can be read clearly without the need to angle them.

NOTE: Charts should always be checked for tick marks AND that the axis isn't cut off.



Example 2

When using line graphs, if the data isn't too crowded add in a **circular** marker. Lines should be at 1.5 pt with a size 4 marker.

If the chart is densely populated then don't use a marker, and judge the lines thickness (no thicker than 1.75pt) depending on how densely populated the chart is.

If it's a very busy chart you won't want the lines too thick because it's hard to identify where the data point falls.

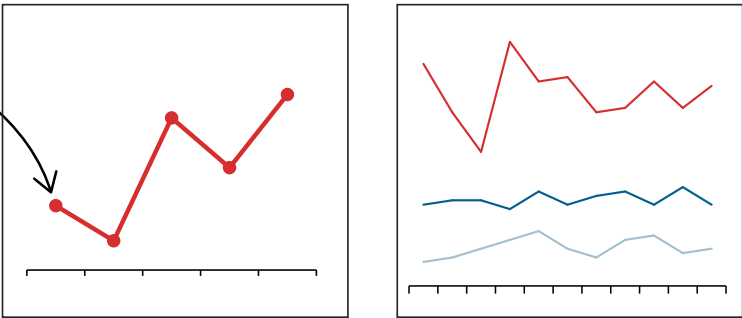
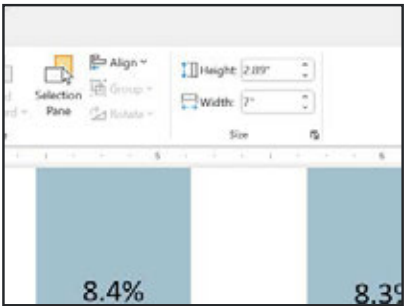


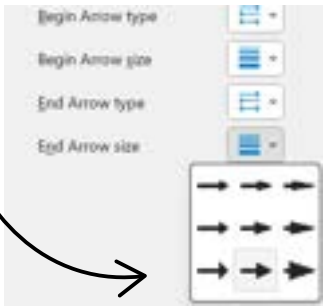
Chart Design

Example 3

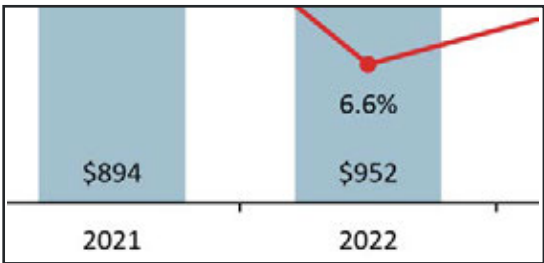
Charts should be sized at **9pt** with a **12pt** callout, ensure the chart is 7" wide.



Arrows should use the bottom middle arrow size, with a 1.5mm wide line.



For a simple chart, don't use any colours for data points other than black or white, depending on which contrast rate sits better. e.g. Black text is best over light blue, and white is best for red.

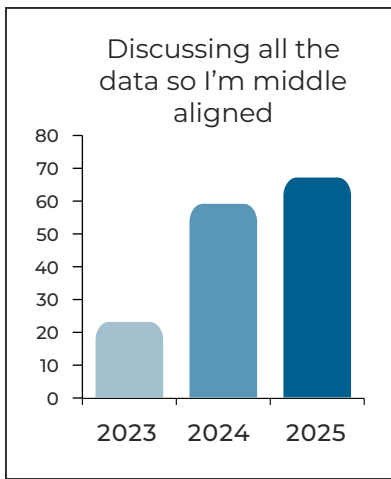
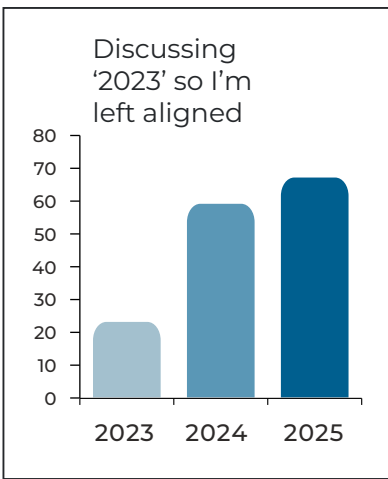
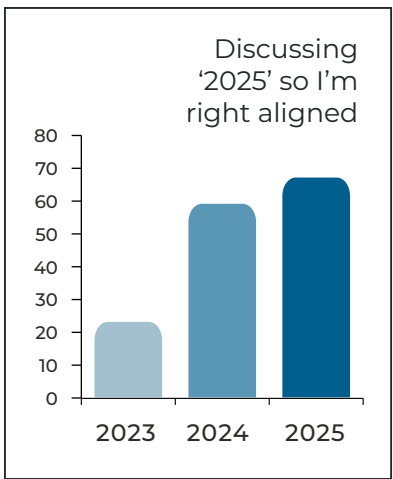


Example 4

Don't tilt or angle CAGR or other callouts. CAGR format should be:

CAGR, YEAR-YEAR: **00.0%**

Callouts should align with the data they discuss, e.g. if discussing 2025 data the callout should align with the side that data is on. If the callout refers to a range the callout can be middle aligned over the discussed data range.



Don't try to fit the callout into a tight space, add white space above the chart for the callout if needed rather than squashing it in.

PDF/Powerpoint Reports

Example 1

Always use guides when altering the design of a powerpoint. This helps to maintain the correct position of headings and left alignments. You can get guides up by right clicking on screen and ticking guides on.



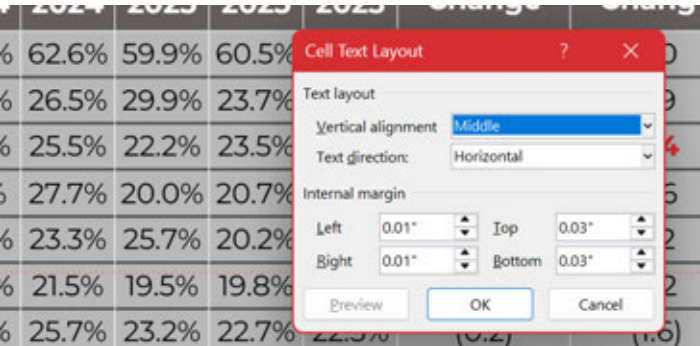
Use guides to maintain position of the headings throughout the report. e.g. H3 heading should be at the same place on page 5 and page 12. Check previous reports if unsure. Try to maintain a good distance between text, headings and charts, If the layout needs to be altered to achieve this, that is fine as long as good balance is kept between all elements.

Example 2

When altering a table, use width and height to ensure even spacing across columns.



Ensure you check cell margins are even on top and bottom so the data is in center of the cell.



Cover Images

NOTE: Please spend the extra time choosing the right cover image, as it's the first visual impression of each report!

Example 1

Try to choose images that have colours either within the main colour panel, or blue. These images should be cool toned, so if the image isn't cool toned already - please edit within photoshop. Use colour balancing or similar to do this, and ensure the image doesn't look overly processed.



Too warm



Edited image with a cooler tone

Example 2

Ensure the images aren't overexposed or poorly taken. Also avoid overly 'busy' images. Ideal images have a singular focus point without too much visual noise.



Overexposed and neon colors



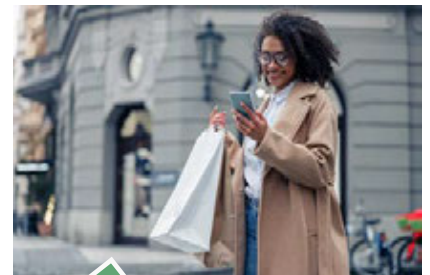
Image has a good focal point and lighting

Example 3

Don't use images that look posed or forced. Instead choose those with natural facial expressions and movements.



Very forced and unnatural



Natural posing and good lighting

Example 4

When using AI images, ensure the image isn't overly distorted and makes sense to look at (check fingers, connecting lines and faces)



Four fingers - looks like AI



AI shouldn't look obviously like AI